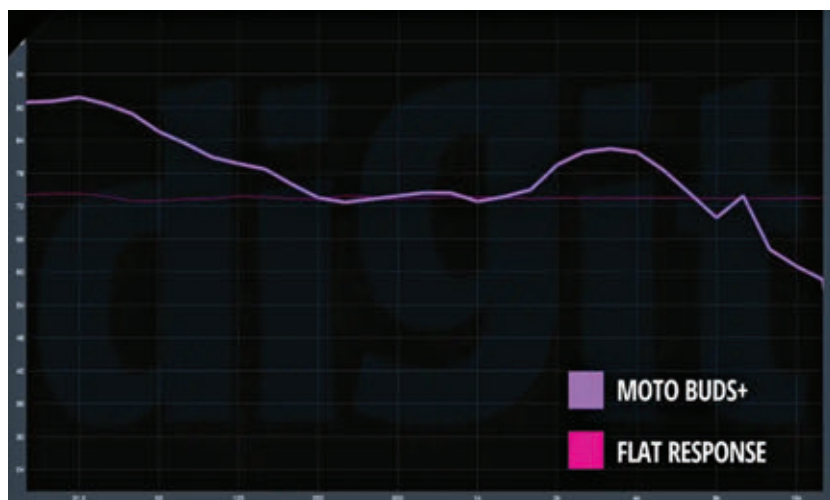




micro planar tweeter, both of which handle different parts of the frequency range, allowing for better separation. The earphones are Hi-Res certified and support Dolby Atmos with Dolby Head Tracking on supported devices. The earbuds support the LHDC5.0, AAC, SBC, and LC3 audio codecs but I'd prefer aptX support over LHDC as its support is more widespread.

The sound is rich in character and depth with excellent soundstage but there are some issues. The bass response is excessively bloated causing severe auditory masking issues. The entire bass frequency range from 20-250 Hz is overemphasised which masks the intricacies of mid and high frequencies. In songs such as Training Season by Dua Lipa, the thumping bass line distorts the vocals and other instruments.

The mids, by themselves, are pristine. They are very close to neutral and vocals sound crisp and clear when the bass isn't too overbearing. For example, these earphones are great when listening to podcasts. The highs also sound decent with good amounts of sparkle and low sibilance. However, the bloated bass isn't too much of an issue given the 10-band EQ customisation you get through the Moto Buds app. I modified the sub-bass region and the sound completely transformed into something much more cohesive.

The OPPO Enco X2 is still the undisputed champion of sound at this

price range. In fact, even the OnePlus Buds Pro 2 has a better default bass response. But, through customisation, you can make the Moto Buds+ sound pretty stellar.

As for call quality, the Moto Buds+ employs a triple microphone system with ENC support. Call quality is fantastic indoors; the speaker's voice is clear and legible even with background noise. When there's wind interference, the quality dips slightly but it's still one of the better mic systems on TWS earphones at this price.

BATTERY LIFE

The Moto Buds+'s battery life is pretty mediocre. It boasts up to 8 hours of playback on the earbuds alone without ANC, and a total of 38 hours of playback with the charging case included. However, with ANC turned on and AAC codec active, I got a playtime of merely 3.5 hours on the earbuds, which is on the lower side.

The charging case topped the earphones up another four times, which brings the total playtime to 17.5 hours with ANC active. The earbuds do come with fast charging though, so a quick 10-minute charge will get you about 1 hour of playtime with ANC active.

VERDICT

The Moto Buds+, co-developed with Bose, offer a feature-rich experience with customisable sound and controls

via a robust companion app, excellent call quality, and fast charging. However, the design is uninspired and the build quality lacks a premium feel, particularly for its ₹9,999 price tag. Despite Bose's expertise, the ANC is underwhelming, especially in noisy environments, and the default sound profile suffers from an overly bloated bass, though this can be adjusted. The earbuds are lightweight and comfortable, ideal for long use and workouts, but the battery life is mediocre, providing only 3.5 hours of playtime with ANC active. Those who prefer a more balanced sound profile would be better off choosing the OPPO Enco X2, but for the casual user, the Moto Buds+ can prove to be a great option despite its shortcomings given its customisability and feature array.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Speakers: Dual dynamic drivers (11mm woofer + 6mm tweeter) | Microphones: 3x microphones (ENC) | Bluetooth version: 5.3 | Active Noise Cancellation: Up to 46 dB | Audio Codecs: LHDC5.0, AAC, SBC, LC3 | Battery life (ANC off): 8 hours (earbuds), 38 hours (with case) | Quick charge: Yes, 10 minutes for 3 hours | Weight (case + earbuds): 42.8 g | Colours: Forest Grey, Beach Sand | Sound technology: Dolby Atmos, Dolby Head Tracking | IP rating: IPX4 (case), IP54 (earbuds)

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